Parent activities to promote child learning and development

Performance Standard
§ 1302.51 Parent activities to promote child learning and development.
(a) A program must promote shared responsibility with parents for children's early learning and development, and implement family engagement strategies that are designed to foster parental confidence and skills in promoting children's learning and development. These strategies must include:

(1) Offering activities that support parent-child relationships and child development including language, dual language, literacy, and bi-literacy development as appropriate;

(2) Providing parents with information about the importance of their child's regular attendance, and partner with them, as necessary, to promote consistent attendance; and,

(3) For dual language learners, information and resources for parents about the benefits of bilingualism and biliteracy.

(b) A program must, at a minimum, offer opportunities for parents to participate in a research-based parenting curriculum that builds on parents' knowledge and offers parents the opportunity to practice parenting skills to promote children's learning and development. A program that chooses to make significant adaptations to the parenting curriculum to better meet the needs of one or more specific populations must work with an expert or experts to develop such adaptations.

Policy

PPS Early Learners program values parents as their child's first teacher and will work to promote shared responsibility with families for their children's early learning and development.

Procedure

a. Early Learners staff work to engage families in their child's education in multiple ways. During enrollment the program will gather input from families on what topics are of interest to them related to their child's education and experience in school.
   1. Examples of specific activities to support parent-child relationships and child development include Administrator Coffee Chats focused on building literacy skills at home, OMSI play dates monthly, Education Home Visits and conferences, workshops on building routines and other health topics, as well as Family Advocate home visits.
   2. During initial home visits in the Fall, the Family Advocate team begins talking to parents/caregivers about the importance of attendance and shares specific information about their child's current percentage of absences. Teachers reinforce this messaging during Fall conferences. Starting in November, the Family Advocate team will work with families whose attendance is below 85% to create a Family Success Plan in order to set goals and create a plan to improve attendance.
   3. The program will share the benefits of bilingualism as a priority for families that speak other languages than English. This begins at enrollment by sharing our Dual Language Immersion classroom options with families. Once enrolled, our DLI classrooms involve parents in the learning process, creating partnerships that can enhance student outcomes.
   4. The program will ensure all communication with families is in multiple languages when possible. The PPS website and communication applications, like Remind, have the capability to translate text into a myriad of languages. This ensures that all parents/caregivers can access important information about their child's education and school activities. This promotes greater parent involvement, strengthens school-family partnerships, and fosters a more inclusive learning environment for students.

DRAFT

b. PPS Early Learners Mental Health Consultants facilitate a research-based parenting series Positive Solutions for Families one time (or more) per year. Translation is offered for anyone who needs it, as well as a virtual option to attend. Initially created by the Center on the Social and Emotional Foundations for Early Learning (CSEFEL) and now available on the National Center for Pyramid Model Innovations (NCPMI) website, and growing out of the PBIS (Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports) practices, this curriculum promotes social-emotional competence in young children and is a straightforward, engaging set of Parent Training Modules to which all parents, guardians, and caregivers of the PPS Early Learners program are invited to attend. The modules include education for parents and caregivers about typical early childhood social-emotional development, opportunities for sharing of ideas, strategies for consistent, effective, and compassionate parenting, as well as opportunities for parents to practice new skills and obtain feedback from the group facilitators.

DRAFT